Spent - A fast paced FPS tactical movement shooter

Spent - A fast paced FPS tactical movement shooter..... 1

Game Pillars -.....2

Core Loop -..... 2

Control & Input Scheme -.....3

Combat System Details -.....3

Technical Considerations -..... 4

Metrics & Success Criteria -.....4

One Pager -..... 5

Story -.....5

Narrative/player type -.....5

Theme/Mood -.....5

Map type -.....6

Theory to what makes a good level design in shooters -.....6

Goals:.....6

Abilities -..... 7

Phases -..... 7

Elements in Game World -.....7

Map Design -..... 8

Pacing Graph -..... 9

Game Flow Chart -.....10

Test Plan -.....10

Changes after UX testing -..... 10

Summary -..... 10

Game Pillars -

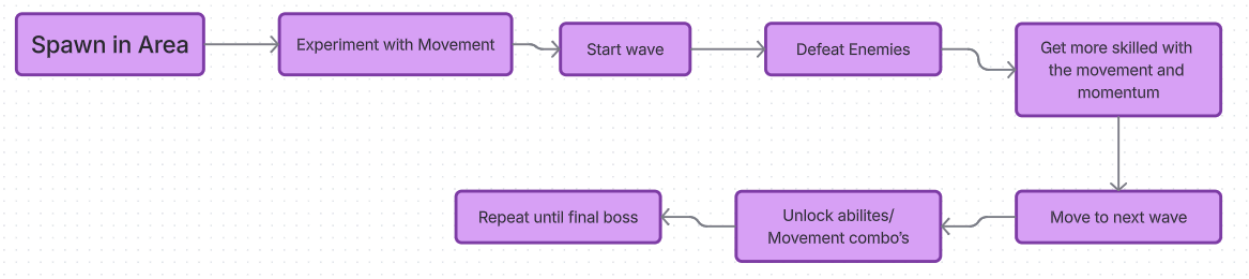
- ***Flow motion:*** *Constant momentum and responsiveness.*

- ***Skill Expression:*** *Mechanics reward precision and timing.*

- ***Stylized Immersion:*** *Distorted visuals reinforce robotic identity.*

- ***Challenge Clarity:*** *Fast-paced but always readable and fair.*

Core Loop -



Player navigates arena using mobility abilities, eliminates waves of enemies, unlocks new chain combos to maintain momentum and efficiency.

Control & Input Scheme -

Action	***Input***	***Notes***
Slide	Ctrl	**When on ground** the player can slide to gain speed, momentum and dodge attacks.
Sprint	Shift	Gradually increase speed.
Grapple	Right click	Grapple on the highlighted areas to gain height and move around faster and easier.
Ground Slam	Ctrl	**When high enough in the air**, ground slam to do AoE damage.
Shoot	Left click	Fire at enemies.
Reload	R	Reload Weapon.
Inspect Weapon	Mouse Btn 4	Inspect weapon animation.
Wall Run(Up)	Shift	**While on a wall**, press shift to move upwards.
Wall Run(Down)	Ctrl	**While on a wall** press ctrl to move downwards.
Jump	Space	Jump on walls, Jump + Ctrl to gain momentum, Jump off walls to gain speed, Jump to dodge attacks.

Combat System Details -

- Enemy archetypes:

- **Grunt: Default enemy, 3 body hits or 1 headshot to defeat**
    - Sit still, tracks the player and shoots slow moving bullets.
- **Heavy: Heavy enemy, 6 body hits or 2 headshots to defeat.**
    - Sits still, tracks the player, shoots slow moving bullets, is larger in size and takes more bullets to take down.
- **Flying: Flying enemy, strafes towards the player while shooting, 3 body hits or 1 headshot to defeat.**
    - Flies in random directions set by parameters towards player & tracks and shoots the player slow moving bullets.
- **Melee: Melee enemy, close range attack, 4 body hits or 2 headshot defeat.**
    - Strafes at random and moves towards the player to deal close range damage.

- Damage Model:

- **Player: Projectile(Fast)**
- **Enemies: Projectile(Medium)**

- Player Feedback:

- **Ground slam particle effect**
- **Grapple rope**
- **Grapple indicator**
- **UI display of ammo and enemies**

Technical Considerations -

Platform- PC

Engine- Unity

Camera- First Person

Target Performance- 60+ fps, 1080p

Metrics & Success Criteria -

Average session time - *10-15 mins.*

Player retention after the first wave - *80%.*

Reports on movement feel - *Mostly positive (7-9/10).*

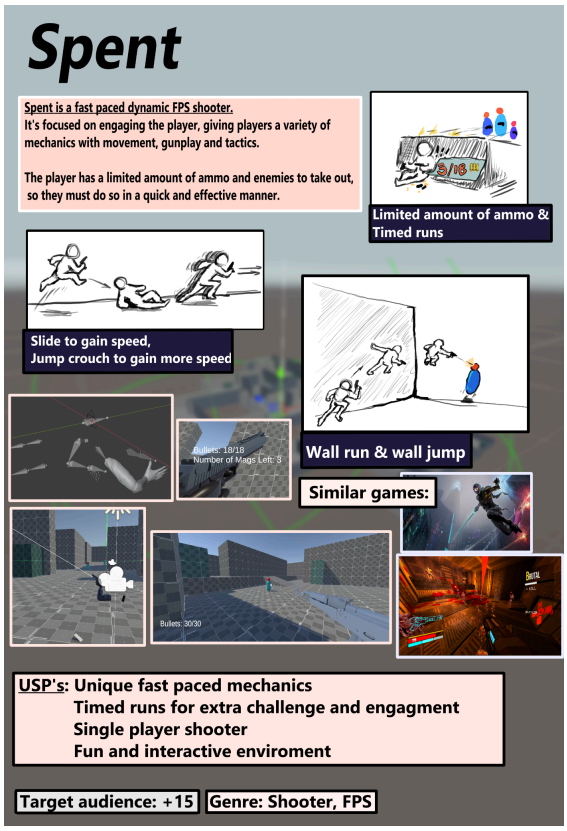
Reports on aesthetic - *Was successful in conveying the robot identity and environmental story telling.*

Player accuracy hit ratio - 50-60%

Players reached final stage ratio - 70%

Player Enjoyment Rating - "Fun and fast paced movement, 7/10"

One Pager -



Story -

You're an advanced human, selected to test out the strength of new implants and AI battle sim

Narrative/player type -

Narrative/player type" could be phrased more formally: "The game is primarily mechanics-driven with minimal narrative, emphasizing fast-paced, skill-based gameplay over story.

Theme/Mood -

The mood I want to convey is fun, excitement and focus.
The player/main character is robotic, so I will convey this through the graphic settings in my game. They will be pixelated and more distorted than a regular game, the player will also see themselves as a robot at the beginning of the game. The setting of the game is an arena/training simulator. Since my internal goals are to create a fast paced, dopamine inducing environment; this sort of unique style will immerse the player more and make it a more fun experience.

Map type -

I want a map that can be interactive in a way that the player can get creative and implement mechanics to achieve the game play goal in a more engaging way.

Concepted interactions:

- Grappling spots
- Time slow
- Destructible walls
- Xray
- Sword
- Hook to pull the enemies

To create this environment I need a map that is a sort of arena where enemies appear systematically where after beating them, you unlock/discover these new mechanics.

Theory to what makes a good level design in shooters -

Flow theory -

The goal is to maintain a balance between challenge and player skill to keep players in the "flow" state.

In level design this means to gradually introduce mechanics, increase complexity and alternate between combat and exploration.

Its practical use; after each wave or enemy encounter, reward with an ability that gives new environmental paths or tactics.

The three C's -

The level geometry should complement the player's movement and camera behaviour.

If the player has a double jump, design vertical areas or if the camera is over the shoulder avoid tight corridors.

Combat Choreography -

The arena is a puzzle, not just a fight.

Arena layouts should guide movement flow, cover, jump pads, weak points, elevated platforms.

Player abilities give new solutions to this combat puzzle.

Goals:

Internal:

To create a game and level design I am proud of and would play myself. To get the player excited and get a feeling of fast pace and fun.

External:

To get through enemy waves while conserving ammo, unlock new mechanics and interact with the environment with fast movement.

Abilities -

Dash Burst - Quickly dash, break through walls and dodge enemy attacks.
Grapple Hook - Target grapple nodes or pull enemies.
Ground Slam - After a jump, slam down to deal an AoE attack.
Time Rift - Slo-mo.

Phases -

Intro wave -
Grunts & 1 Heavy Unit.
Focus: Learn dash and grapple to avoid enemies and learn movement.

Mobility wave -
Flying enemies & melee rushers.
Player dash, grapple, slam combos.

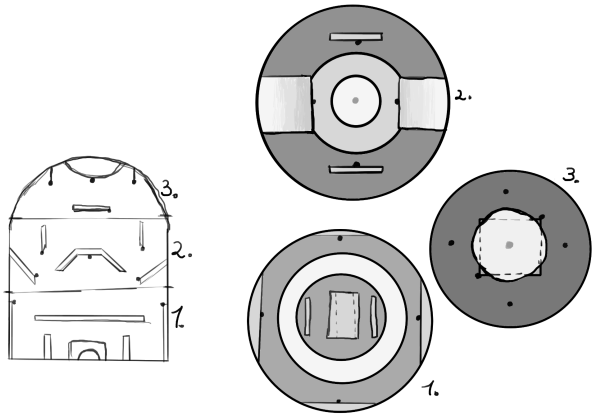
Environmental hazard wave -
Timed platforms, breakable walls
Introduce time rift ability

(Boss) Final stages -
Enemy with AoE attacks.
Enemies that were introduced before appear.
The player has to use verticality and exploit weak spots.

Elements in Game World -

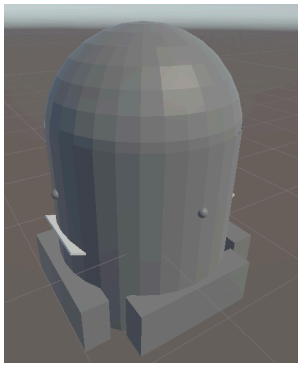
NPC's -
There will be different types of enemies with unique behaviours that react to the player's presence. Such as flying, strafing & shooting.
Pickups -
There will be ammo pickups occasionally since the player has a limited amount, the player has abilities so no sort of upgrade power ups are needed.
Props -
There will be futuristic textures and environment to further immerse the player.
Meaningful interactions -
There will be grappling spots, the player can slide, jump crouch to gain momentum, crouch high in the air to slam into the ground to do damage and be able to run on walls and jump.

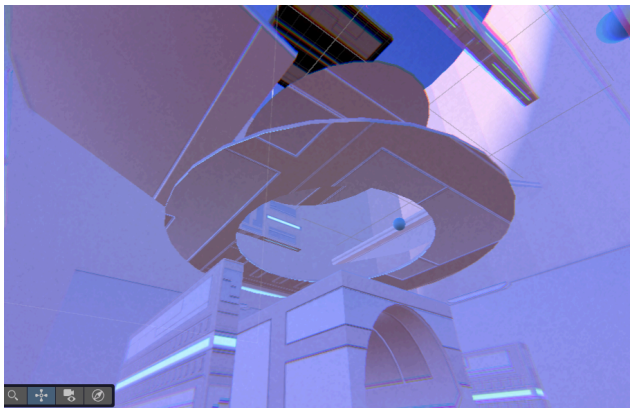
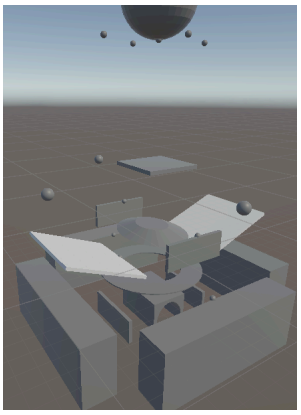
Map Design -



I went for a 3 stage arena dome with different places to find cover, grapple and have a good movement flow. I split it into 3 layers for easier understanding and design.

Enemies will be spawning on most surfaces on the map and the player has to adapt to their placements, get into a flow with their movement and fast pace. Some enemies will charge at the player, others will stand still and their spawn locations vary depending on their attributes.

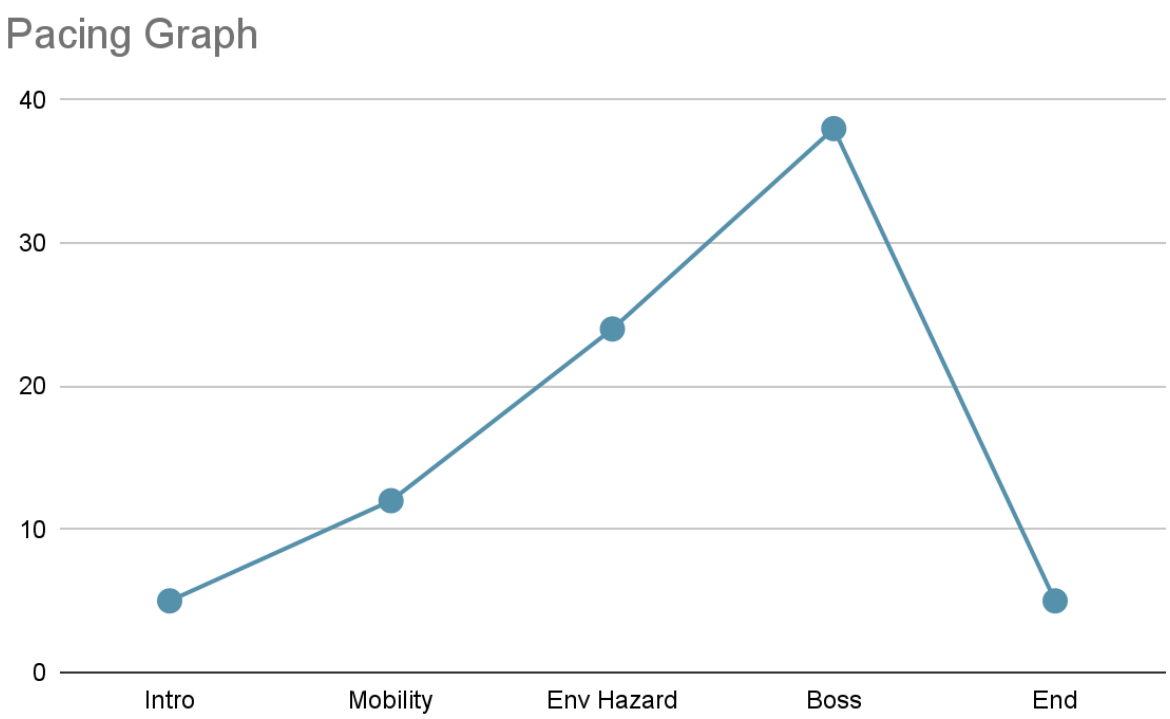

Outside of map



Inside of map/Textured

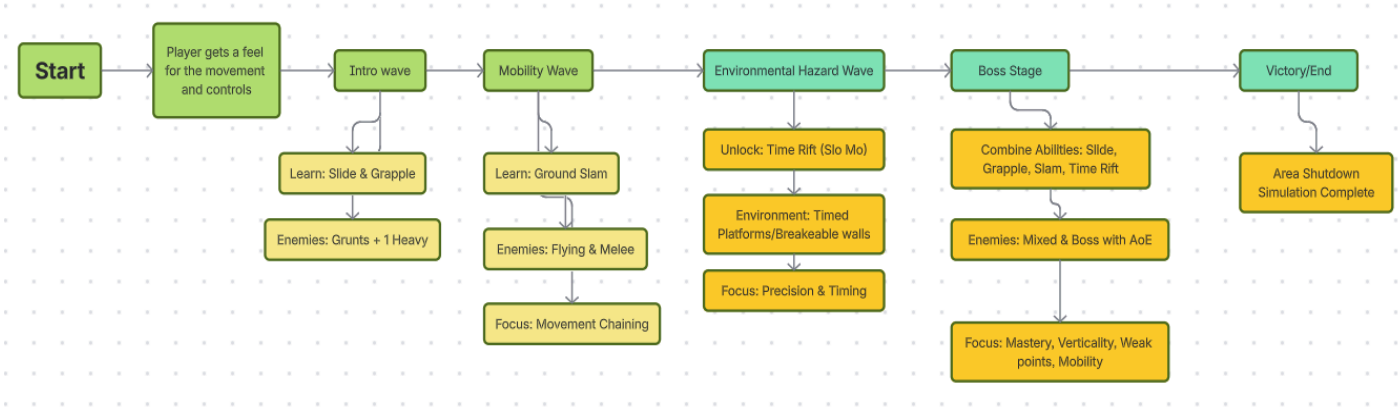
Pacing Graph -

The pacing graph visualizes **player intensity**; combining combat difficulty, movement complexity, and emotional engagement. Over the course of the game's waves and phases.

Phase	***Description***	***Intensity Level***	***Emotional Goal***	***UX***
Intro Wave	Introduced to movement, grapple and dash.	Low - Medium	Curiosity/Learning	Player learns basic movement.
Mobility Wave	Add flying and tougher enemies.	Medium - High	Excitement/Challenge	Player gets used to mechanics and chains them, maintaining flow.
Environmental Hazard Wave	Introduces environmental hazards and time slow ability.	High	Focus/Pressure	Complexity spikes.
Boss Final Stage	Boss, mixed enemy types and verticality.	Peak	Adrenaline/Mastery	Full skill test.
Resolution/End	Victory moment.	Low	Satisfaction	Player reflects on mastery.



Game Flow Chart -



Test Plan -

- Ask player about movement feel
- Ask player about movement/environment intuition(How easy is it to understand)
- Ask player about what mood/vibe they got from the games aesthetic & visuals
- Ask player how they like the map(More vertical or linear)
- Ask player about new possible mechanics

Feedback:
- Movement feels smooth and fast paced
- Fix some UI fonts
- Aesthetic of the game is successful
- Linear map
- Maybe a grapple towards the enemy

Changes after UX testing -

- More intuitive UX indicators, like grapples & UI.
- Further specify interactions and world building (in Game Design Document).

Summary -

Spent is a **fast-paced first-person tactical movement shooter** focused on maintaining momentum, rewarding player skill, and delivering a stylized, immersive experience. The gameplay centers on chaining mobility mechanics, such as **grappling, sliding, wall-running and ground slamming**, to outmaneuver enemies and maintain flow.

The combat system blends **precision shooting and reactive movement**, supported by readable feedback and a fair gradual challenge curve. The **arena-style map** encourages verticality and creative traversal movement, evolving through phases that introduce new mechanics and enemy types. Each wave builds intensity and complexity, pushing players toward mastery while preserving that feeling of excitement and flow.

Developed in **Unity for PC**, *Spent* targets smooth 60+ FPS performance and visual immersion through a **robotic, distorted aesthetic** that reinforces its theme. UX testing confirmed the game's strong movement feel and aesthetic success, leading to refinements in UI clarity and environmental interaction cues.

Ultimately, *Spent* aims to deliver a **high-skill, momentum-driven shooter** experience where movement, precision, and flow define both gameplay and player satisfaction.

Assets & References(Not my own):

Category	***Asset Name***	***Sources/Notes***	***Ownership***
Texture	**Sci-fi Material Textures**	**Not including grapple points or grapple indicators.**	**Fully implemented**
Model & Animation	**Weapon FPS Model Animations**	**-**	**Fully implemented**
Font	**valueOldCaps**	**Used for Enemy Spawner & Menu text.**	**Fully implemented**
Script(Partially used)	**PlayerMovement Script**	**Not including these mechanics, they're on separate scripts: Sliding , Grappling, WallRunning & GroundSlamming).**	**Partially implemented**
Script	**Enemy Shooting Behaviour**	**Bullet shooting script.**	**Fully implemented**
VFX	**Ground slam particle effects**	**Used for the ground slam ability VFX.**	**Fully implemented**
Model	**Ammo models**	**Ammo pick up model.**	**Fully implemented**
Script	**Gun Sway, Gun Settings & Weapon Switching.**	**Not the weapon bullet shooting script.**	**Fully implemented**

Links were not recorded and could not be traced.